

Setting Up a Call Centre with Asterisk

A call centre is essential for businesses as it facilitates customer service, supports sales, and enhances the reputation of a brand. Here's an overview of its importance, proprietary software options, and why Asterisk is a valuable open source alternative. Also, learn how to set up a basic call centre using Asterisk.



Call centres are an essential component of modern businesses for several reasons.

- **Customer service:** These centres manage large volumes of enquiries, ensuring prompt support.
- **Sales and lead generation:** They assist in engaging potential customers and converting leads.
- **Feedback collection:** Outbound calls allow businesses to gather valuable customer feedback.
- **Brand building:** Effective call handling improves customer satisfaction and brand reputation.
- **Business continuity:** They act as a fallback for customer support during crises.

Popular proprietary software for setting up a call centre are:

- **Genesys:** Scalable, AI-integrated software with CRM and workforce optimisation.
- **Cisco Contact Center:** Comes with robust security and multi-channel support.
- **Five9:** Has predictive dialling and real-time monitoring

with CRM integration.

- **Zendesk Talk:** Integrates with Zendesk support; suitable for support-focused setups.
- **Avaya Contact Center:** Has comprehensive features with cloud/on-premises options.

These solutions offer extensive features and support but can be costly for small businesses. Asterisk is a popular, open source alternative for the call centre. It is a software implementation of a private branch exchange (PBX), in conjunction with suitable telephony hardware interfaces and network applications.

Why choose Asterisk as an alternative to proprietary software

Cost savings: Asterisk is open source, eliminating licensing fees and reducing costs; hence it's ideal for small to mid-sized businesses.

Customisability: It's fully customisable, allowing tailored configurations for IVR, call routing, and reporting.